The Remnant Church

Purpose: *To Discover which Church is theremnant church of the last days.*

Centred on: *Since JESUS gives his life his sheep follow him wherever he goes.*

Introduction

Is it confusing to you that there are so many varying denominations that teach so many different doctrines all from the same book? (33,000)

1 Corinthians 14: 33… God is not responsible for the vast confusing sea of doctrine. Is God the author of confusion, no. So who is?

John 10: 11-12… Here Satan is depicted as the one whom "scatters" the sheep. But is it likely that the good shepherd would just sit back and do nothing about this problem? Or would it be likely that the good shepherd would have a counter plan to regain his flock?

John 10: 16… **Question:** How many flocks does Jesus want? And what is his plan.

Answer: one. To bring them back together

Question: Now, how does Jesus intend to bring people to his flock?

Answer: His voice?

2 Timothy 3: 16… All scripture is given by inspiration "God breathed," in other words, the voice of Jesus.

Question: It's easy to say you'll go wherever God leads you to go. But will you commit right now to go where God is calling you?

We will look at six characteristics from the voice of Jesus as to what is the one fold that he is leading his people into:

1 Timothy 3: 14-15…**Question:** According to this verse, what is the characteristic of the true church of the living God that the voice of Jesus Christ is calling us into?

Answer: The pillar and ground/foundation of the truth. So in essence, can we be the true church if we teach doctrine that is fundamentally different to that of the Bible? (John 16:13)

Revelation 12: 1… Note the term great "sign". Is this symbolic? Of course! So what message was John tying to present? What does the woman symbolise?

In the NT the true church is at times represented by a woman;

2 Corinthians 11: 2… Paul here is comparing the church to the kind of person who gets married to a husband. The bride of Christ.

Ephesians 5: 25-32… Again we see a comparison of Gods relationship with his church to that of a marriage of Husband and wife. (Song of Solomon and Hosea).

The same figures appeared in the Old Testament;

Isaiah 54: 5-6… Husband? The Lord has called you like a woman.

Jeremiah 6: 2… Zion is another name for Jerusalem (church).

When Gods church apostatized it was compared with a corrupt woman;

Jeremiah 3: 20… As a wife treacherously departs/divorces her Husband".

Ezekiel 23: 2-4… "One mother". The two cities, Samaria and Jerusalem, had one common mother, the Hebrew people. They had a common ancestry.

"In their youth". They are represented as having had a separate existence even during the period of the sojourn in Egypt. It was in their "youth" that they had become alienated from God. At this time Israel was still considered unmarried. The marriage with Jehovah took place when the covenant was made at Sinai (Ex. 19).

Revelation 17: 1-3… Here we see a woman/church that has departed from God.

In Rev. 12 the woman represents the true church. Since she is presented as about to give birth to Christ (see vs. 2, 4, 5) and later as being persecuted, following the ascension of Christ (vs. 5, 13–17), she represents the church of both the OT and the NT. Compare Acts 7:38.

Revelation 12: 2-6… Sign # 1: Woman pregnant, sign # 2: Dragon standing before the woman intending to kill her new born. (This child poses a threat to the Dragon).

Revelation 12: 5-6… Who is this male child? Jesus **(Revelation 19: 15).** Note in verse 6, the woman is said to flee into the wilderness for a period of 1260 prophetic days/literal years. Why?

Revelation 12: 13… Due to severe persecution. Satan failed to kill Christ, so his attention now goes to that which Christs values the most: His Church. The persecution gets so bad that the church has to flee into hiding for a period of time which de-enables it to have a public, corporate, organised body.

So there is a space in Christian history where the true church did not exist publically. So if we could identify this period of time, we could then know that the true church of the living God, that Jesus' voice is calling everybody into could not have a public organised body till after this point in time.

Question: how long did the Antichrist reign for?

Answer: 1260 years. This is why the woman had to flee into the wilderness.

Therefore the wilderness time period ended in AD 1798. * (See appendix).**

Satan makes war with Jesus then the church which fled then the remnant…

Ezekiel 4:6… Understanding that the church disappeared for 1260 years to escape persecution helps us to identify the true church, the remnant, because the remnant does not appear until after that time. The 1260 year period ended in 1798 which means the remnant would appear after that point in time so any church that functioned as a public congregation prior to that point in time could not be the remnant church of Bible Prophecy.

Revelation 12: 17… Satan is enraged with the woman in that he was unable to completely destroy her. Here In verse 17, Satan is depicted as focusing his attention on the "rest of her offspring" and gives two identifying characteristics of this remnant group.

- Keep the commandments of God. (Believe, teach and obey the Ten Commandments).
- Have the testimony of Jesus. (Believe in Old {the way Jesus and Paul accepted it, not the view of the modern churches, i.e. Works} and New Testament).

John 5: 39…Jesus is declaring that the scriptures are they that testify of him. This is obviously the Old Testament he is referring to as the New Testament had not been written yet.

Revelation 14:6…Angel: ἄγγελος [*aggelos* /**ang**·EL·OS/], simply means messenger. God has a last day message for the entire world. Is it logical that the people preaching this message would be his true church? Gods' true church must be a worldwide movement.

Revelation 14:7…Notice that the verse says "for the hour of his judgement *has* come." The true church preaches a "present tense" judgement message.

Summary:

- Teach accurate Bible based doctrine.
- The true church fled into the wilderness for a period of 1260 years.
- Keep the Commandments of God.
- Have the testimony of Jesus.
- A worldwide organisation. (Catholics, JW's, Mormons, SDA's)
- Preach a "present tense" judgment message.

John 10: 16…Not of this fold. Is Christ truly your Shepard? Are you willing to listen to his voice?

The New Testament church was an organised body of believers.

Acts 15: 1-6…The Jerusalem council. The general conference get together to have a meeting.

APPEAL:

I went to talk to Jesus about the difficulty of this decision and what I have to give up but I found him on a cross. All his friends were gone he had to make that decision without his friends approval. What did he give up?
The question is not what should I do but rather what will I do?

DEFENT IT! (Difficult Texts):

Church is spiritual / Not an organization:

Revelation 12:17 – Its left from the original and is composed of the elements of the original Apostolic Church. Was it organized?

Acts 15

True believers worship in all churches:
John 4:23, 24
Amos 3:7
John 16:13
John 10:16

You think adventists are better
For God to call a people is not to suppose that he Loves one group more than another . God is organized and he wanted to use Israel to reach the world.

You are claiming that all other Christians are fake:
Romans 8:14
Galatians 3:22
Luke 9:49, 50

Appendix: The Remnant Church

The Book Titled "The History of the Christian Church" is not a religious manual; it is a secular historical account of the Christian Church. Note the following statement;

"The Roman Church States power became supreme in Christendom in AD 538 due to the letter of Roman Emperor Justinian, known as Justinian's decree which set up acknowledged the Bishop of Rome as the head of all churches. It gave the Roman Church State political power, civil power as well as ecclesiastical power. This letter became a part of Justinian's code, the fundamental law of the empire and that year pope Vigilius ascended the papal chair under the military protection of Belisarius."

History of the Christian Church, Vol. 3, p. 327.

"In 1798 General Berthier made his entrance into Rome, abolished the papal government, and established a secular one."

Encyclopaedia Britannica 1941 edition.

Papacy, Plans of the French to Destroy (1798):

The object of the French directory was the destruction of the pontifical government, as the irreconcilable enemy of the republic… The aged pope [Pius VI] was summoned to surrender the temporal government; on his refusal, he was dragged from the altar… His rings were torn from his fingers, and finally, after declaring the temporal power abolished, the victors carried the pope prisoner into Tuscany, whence he never returned (1798).

The Papal States, converted into the Roman Republic, were declared to be in perpetual alliance with France, but the French general was the real master at Rome… The territorial possessions of the clergy and monks were declared national property, and their former owners cast into prison. The papacy was extinct: not a vestige of its existence remained; and among all the Roman Catholic powers not a finger was stirred in its defence. The Eternal City had not longer prince or pontiff; its bishop was a dying captive in foreign lands; and the decree was already announced that no successor would be allowed in his place.

Source: George Trevor, Rome: From the Fall of the Western Empire (London: The Religious Tract Society, 1868), pp. 439, 440.

Papacy — Pope, Captivity of (1798)—Dissolution of Pope's Rule, Feb. 15:

That the head of the church might be made to feel with more poignancy his humiliating situation, the day chosen for planting the tree of liberty on the capitol was the anniversary of his election to the sovereignty. Whilst he was, according to custom, in the Sistine chapel, celebrating his accession to the papal chair, and receiving the congratulations of the Cardinals, Citizen Haller, the commissary-general, and Cervoni, who then commanded the French troops within the city, gratified themselves in a peculiar triumph over this unfortunate potentate. During that ceremony they both entered the chapel, and Haller announced to the sovereign Pontiff on his throne, that his reign was at an end.

The poor old man seemed shocked at the abruptness of this unexpected notice, but soon recovered himself with becoming fortitude; and when General Cervoni, adding ridicule to oppression, presented him the national cockade, he rejected it with a dignity that showed he was still superior to his misfortunes. At the same time that his Holiness received this notice of the dissolution of his power, his Swiss guards were dismissed, and Republican soldiers put in their place

Source: Richard Duppa, A Brief Account of the Subversion of the Papal Government. 1798 (2d ed.; London: G. G. and J. Robinson, 1799), pp. 46, 47.

Papacy — Pope, Captivity of (1798), Thought a Death Blow to the Papacy:

When, in 1797, Pope Pius VI. fell grievously ill, Napoleon gave orders that in the event of his death no successor should be elected to his office, and that the Papacy should be discontinued.

But the Pope recovered; the peace was soon broken; Berthier entered Rome on 10th February 1798, and proclaimed a Republic. The aged Pontiff refused to violate his oath by recognizing it, and was hurried from prison to prison into France. Broken with fatigue and sorrows, he died … [in] August 1799, in the French fortress of Valence, aged 82 years. No wonder that half Europe thought Napoleon's veto would be obeyed, and that with the Pope the Papacy was dead.

Source: Joseph Rickaby, "The Modern Papacy," in Lectures on the History of Religions, Vol. 3, [lecture 24, p. 1] (London: Catholic Truth Society, 1910).